

Rainbow's End

..A NOVEL..

BY REX BEACH

Author of
"The Iron Trail," "The Spoilers,"
"Heart of the Sunset," etc.

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Once the first excitement had abated and a messenger had been sent to town, Cueto drew Esteban aside and questioned him.

"A shocking tragedy and most peculiar," said the overseer. "Nothing could amaze me more. Tell me, how did you come to be there at such an hour, eh?"

Esteban saw the malevolent curiosity in Cueto's face and started. "That is my affair. Surely you don't think—"

"Come, come! You can trust me," the overseer winked and smiled.

"I had business that took me there," Esteban declared the younger man.

"Exactly! And a profitable business it proved!" Cueto laughed openly now. "Well, I don't mind telling you Donna Isabel's death is no disappointment to anyone. Anybody could see—"

"Stop!" Esteban was turning alternately red and white. "You seem to imply something outrageous."

"Now let us be sensible. I understand you perfectly, my boy. But an officer of the Guardia Civil may arrive at any moment and he will want to know how you came to be with your stepmother when she plunged into that trap. So prepare yourself."

Young Varona was watching his inquisitor now with a faintly speculative frown. When Cueto had finished, Esteban said:

"You would like me to confess to some black iniquity that would make us better friends, eh? Well, it so happens that I was not alone tonight, but that another person saw the poor woman's death and can bear me out in everything I say. No, Pancho, you overreach yourself. Now, then—Esteban was quick-tempered, and for years he had struggled against an instinctive distrust and dislike of the plantation manager—remember that I have become the head of this house, and your employer. You will do better to think of your own affairs than of mine. I intend to have a careful reckoning with you. I think you know I have a good head for figures." Turning his back upon the elder man, he walked away.

Now it did not occur to Cueto really to doubt the boy's innocence, though the circumstances of Donna Isabel's death were suspicious enough to raise a question in any mind; but in view of Esteban's threat he thought it wise to protect himself by setting a backfire.

As he sat on an old stone bench, moodily recapturing the catastrophe as Esteban had described it, his attention fell upon an envelope at his feet. It was sealed; it was unaddressed. Cueto idly broke it open and began to read. Before he had gone far he started; then he cast a furtive glance about. But the place was secluded; he was unobserved. When he finished reading he rose, smiling. He no longer feared Esteban. On the contrary, he rather pitied the young fool; for here between his fingers was that which not only promised to remove the boy from his path forever, but to place in his hands the entire Varona estates.

One afternoon, perhaps a week later, Don Mario de Castano came puffing and blowing up to the quinta, demanding to see Rosa without a moment's delay. With a directness unusual even in him, Don Mario began:

"Rosa, my dear, you and Esteban have been discovered! I was at lunch with the commandante when I learned the truth. Through friendship I prevailed upon him to give you an hour's grace."

"What do you mean, Don Mario?" inquired the girl.

"Come, come!" the planter cried, impatiently. "Don't you see you can trust me? Heaven! The recklessness, the folly of young people! Could you not leave this insurrection to your elders? Or perhaps you thought it a matter of no great importance, an amusing thing—"

"Don Mario!" Rosa interrupted. "I don't know what you are talking about."

"You don't, eh?" The caller's wet cheeks grew redder; he blew like a porpoise. "Then call Esteban quickly! There is not a moment to lose." When the brother appeared De Castano blurted out at him accusingly: "Well, sir! A fine fix you've put yourself in. Perhaps you will be interested to learn that Colonel Fernandez has issued orders to arrest you and your sister as agents of the insurgents."

"What?" Esteban drew back. Rosa turned white as a lily and laid a fluttering hand upon her throat.

"You two will sleep tonight in San Severino," grimly announced the rosy-faced visitor. "You know what that means."

Rosa uttered a smothered cry. "Colonel Fernandez," Don Mario proceeded, impressively, "did me this favor, knowing me to be a suitor for Rosa's hand. In spite of his duty and the evidence he—"

"Evidence? What evidence?" Esteban asked sharply.

"For one thing, your own letter to Lopez, the rebel, warning him to beware of the trap prepared for him in Santa Clara, and advising him of the government force at Sabánilla. Oh, don't try to deny it! I read it with my own eyes, and it means—death."

Rosa said faintly: "Esteban! I warned you."

Esteban was taken aback, but it was plain that he was not in the least frightened. "They haven't caught me yet," he laughed.

also?" Rosa eyed the caller anxiously. "Exactly!" "Who accuses her, and of what?" Esteban demanded. "That also I have discovered through the courtesy of Colonel Fernandez. Your accuser is none other than Pancho Cueto."

"Cueto!"

"Yes; he has denounced both of you as rebels, and the letter is only part of his proof, I believe. Now, then, you can guess why I am here. I am not



"Your Accuser Is None Other Than Pancho Cueto."

without influence; I can save Rosa, but for you, Esteban, I fear I can do nothing. You must look out for yourself. Well? What do you say?"

When Esteban saw how pale his sister had grown, he took her in his arms, saying gently: "I'm sorry, dear. It's all my fault." Then to the merchant:

"It's very good of you to warn us."

"Ha!" Don Mario fanned himself. "I'm glad you appreciate my efforts. It's a good thing to have the right kind of a friend. I'll marry Rosa within an hour, and I fancy my name will be a sufficient shield."

Rosa turned to her elderly suitor and made a deep courtesy. "I am unworthy of the honor," said she. "You see, I—I do not love you, Don Mario." "Love!" exploded the visitor. "God bless you! What has love to do with the matter? Esteban will have to ride for his life in ten minutes and your property will be seized. So you had better make yourself ready to go with me."

But Rosa shook her head.

"Eh? What says you? What do you expect to do?"

"I shall go with Esteban," said the girl.

This calm announcement seemed to stupefy De Castano. He sat down heavily in the nearest chair, and with his wet handkerchief poised in one pudgy hand he stared fixedly at the speaker. His eyes were round and bulging, the sweat streamed unheeded from his temples. He resembled some queer bloated marine monster just emerged from the sea and momentarily dazzled by the light.

"You—You're mad," he finally gasped. "Esteban, tell her what it means."

But this Esteban could not do, for he himself had not the faintest notion of what was in store for him. War seemed to him a glorious thing; he had been told that the hills were peopled with patriots. He was very young, his heart was ablaze with hatred for the Spaniards and for Pancho Cueto. He longed to risk his life for a free Cuba. Therefore he said: "Rosa shall do as she pleases. If we must be exiles we shall share each other's hardships. It will not be for long."

"Idiot!" stormed the fat man. "Better that you gave her to the sharks below San Severino. There is no law, no safety for women outside of the cities. The island is in anarchy. These patriots you talk about are the blacks, the mulattoes, the—lowest, laziest savages in Cuba."

"Please! Don Mario!" the girl pleaded. "I cannot marry you, for—I love another."

"Eh?"

"I love another. I'm betrothed to O'Reilly, the American—and he's coming back to marry me."

De Castano twisted himself laboriously out of his chair and waddled toward the door. He was purple with rage and mortification. On the threshold he paused to wheeze: "Very well, then. Go! I'm done with both of you. I would have lent you a hand with this rascal Cueto, but now he will fall heir to your entire property. Well, it is a time for handlets! I—I—"

Unable to think of a parting speech sufficiently bitter to match his disappointment, Don Mario plunged out into the sunlight, muttering and stammering to himself.

Within an hour the twins were on their way up the Yumuri, toward the home of Anesio and Evangelina; for it was thither that they naturally turned. It was well that they had made haste, for as they rode down into the valley, up the other side of the hill from Matanzas came a squad of the Guardia Civil, and at its head rode Pancho Cueto.

(Continued in next issue.)

HUN ARMY IS REDUCED 85 PER CENT BY ALLIES

WASHINGTON, April 5.—The central powers military forces have been reduced to a total of 1,125,000 men, or 15 per cent. of their strength at the time of the signing of the armistice, while the allies have retained 75 per cent. or 13,333,000 of their military strength. This was revealed by General Peyton C. March, chief of staff, at his weekly conference with the members of the press today. These figures, General March stated, were furnished from Europe, and include

WILSON SHOULD COOPERATE SAY REPUBLICANS

WASHINGTON, April 7.—The Republican Publicity Association through its President, Hon. Jonathan Loring, issued a statement from its Washington headquarters:

"If President Wilson's frame of mind is the same now that it has been in the past six years, he will expect Congress to co-operate with him by accepting his leadership and yielding to his judgment where their opinions differ from his upon public questions. The logic of the situation, however, requires him to co-operate with Congress and to yield his preconceived notions where he and Congress differ."

"The Sixty-Six Congress represents in a peculiar and indisputable manner the latest expression of the will of the American people. The mandate from the people to the government as expressed in the election of this Congress is two years subsequent to the mandate expressed in the election of President Wilson. If the campaign and election had been attended by no unusual circumstances the result would be unmistakably the latest expression of the popular will."

"But the election of 1918 had an extraordinary significance. Shortly before the ballots were cast, President Wilson issued a very carefully considered and strongly worded appeal to the voters of the country for the election of a Congress in sympathy with him. His appeal was read and discussed in every voting precinct in the United States. Doubtless hundreds of thousands of voters yielded to the plea because it was based largely upon the representation that a Congress in sympathy with the President was essential to the successful conclusion of war and negotiation of peace. But in the face of this unprecedented plea, the people of the country deliberately and decisively registered their desire to have the policies of their government shaped by men not in sympathy with Wilsonian ideas and practices."

"President Wilson lays claim to peculiar powers in reading the public mind. He has repeatedly made allusions to his clear understanding of public opinion and desire. But such a claim can have no possible foundation in view of the clear, deliberate and decisive action of the people at the polls last November."

"The Sixty-sixth Congress was chosen as a repudiation of Democratic administration. It was a vote of confidence in the constructive ability of Republicans. It was an expression of desire that the policies of the government be formed by the men most recently placed in control, and the country will expect President Wilson to keep that fact in mind if any differences arise between himself and Congress."

PROBE ASKED ON SYSTEM OF COURT MARTIAL

WASHINGTON, April 8.—Investigation by the attorney-general's office of the alleged distribution in official franker envelopes of 70,000 copies of a letter, written by Colonel John H. Wigmore, formerly of the provost marshal-general's office, in support of the existing court-martial system, was urged today by Senator Chamberlain, former chairman of the senate military affairs committee, in a letter to Attorney-General Palmer.

Senator Chamberlain charged that "the Wigmore letter was in form and substance a purely private communication upon a purely professional subject," and that it was designed in part as a personal reply to Senator Chamberlain's speech on military justice in the senate, January 3.

SEC. BAKER IS CRITICIZED BY CHAMBERLAIN

NATCHEZ, Miss., April 4.—"But for the things I have said in the past three years, the secretary of war would have accomplished nothing in the last three years," Senator Chamberlain, of Oregon, declared here last night in reply to a statement made yesterday by Secretary Baker that "he could not recall a single instance in which he had received a helpful suggestion from the senator."

"Mr. Baker has steadily followed the suggestions made by the chairman and members of the military affairs committee," Senator Chamberlain continued, "but claimed them all as his own after he had been driven to their adoption."

PARIS, April 4.—In a statement to the Petit Parisien, Premier Lloyd George of Great Britain denies there are dissensions between France and England regarding guarantees for France against Germany. He declares that the understanding between the two governments is complete and that England is "ready to make fresh sacrifices, if necessary, to secure the peace and independence of France."

The interview was sought, says a Havas agency summary of it, because of a rumor recently in circulation to the effect that Great Britain would oppose in the peace conference the French demands for guarantees.

Rosenburg gets a new two-story of.

President Wilson Confined to Bed

PARIS, April 4.—President Wilson is confined to his room today with a severe cold.

Rear-Admiral Grayson, the president's physician, sent the president to bed as a preventive measure. The cold developed last night.

The president, who retired at 8 o'clock last night, rested comfortably through the night. The president has a fair degree of fever, although just what his temperature is has not been revealed.

AMERICANS PREPARING TO REPULSE BOLSHEVIKI

LONDON, April 4.—American reinforcements are being sent into Northern Russia to fight the Bolsheviks, it was learned today. The troops are going to Murmansk, where the situation is said to be critical.

The Bolsheviks are preparing for another drive on the Archangel front, it is stated.

More British troops are expected to arrive in Russia by the end of next month to relieve the forces now under pressure.

LONDON, April 4.—In the attack by the Bolsheviks against the allied front in the Belozarski sector of the Archangel front on Wednesday, the Reds suffered heavy losses, said an Exchange Telegraph dispatch from Archangel today.

The McKinley sawmill at Bend to be rebuilt.

WESTERN SOLDIERS ARRIVE IN NEW YORK

NEW YORK, April 5.—A Camp Lewis detachment of the 337th infantry, which arrived Friday on the Fredrick, is at Camp Merritt today. It is made up of Oregon, Washington, Montana and Idaho men and will remain only about a week before dispatch to Camp Lewis. Other units which arrived carrying Oregon men are aero squadrons that have seen service in France. A few of these were there only a short time, but the majority of these lads who have done the ground or mechanical work for the aviation have been in France long enough to qualify as veterans. There is only one thing these men want and that it to go home and forget the war. They have no use for peace time soldiering and are eager, if not chafing, to get home.

Among the Clackamas county boys to arrive at this camp is Sergeant Leroy C. Porter of Gladstone.

The Morning Enterprise is desirous of having parties, entertainments, and all kinds of social functions, especially for the Sunday issue, and those giving such affairs, or knowing of same, may phone or send into the Enterprise, and they will appear in the paper. Locals, such as persons coming and going, those who are ill, and births are also desired, and in fact any kind of news that will interest the many readers of the local paper will be greatly appreciated. Ed. Phone Pacific Main 2, or Home Phone, B-10.

WILSON FAVORS INDEPENDENCE OF PHILIPPINES

WASHINGTON, April 4.—Members of the special mission of the Philippine legislature here, seeking immediate independence for the islands, were told today by Secretary Baker that he spoke President Wilson's mind when he said he believed the time had come to grant the complete independence desired by the Filipino people.

The war secretary also said he believed the mission would be able to carry home word that the American people loved liberty too dearly to deny it to others.

PEACE PACT READY FOR SIGNING BY NEXT WEEK

PARIS, April 4.—The opinion was expressed tonight by responsible British authorities that the peace treaty would be ready for signing by Wednesday next.

LONDON, April 4.—The Paris correspondent of the Daily Telegraph telegraphs that he is able to state on the highest authority that by next Sunday a complete agreement will have been reached by the council of four.

LABOR BUYS LOT
PORTLAND, April 3.—By a deal closed Wednesday through E. J. Daly the Portland Labor Temple association acquired a 50x100 lot on the east side of Fourth street, between Jefferson and Columbia streets. The price paid for the property was \$13,500.

RECORD WHEAT CROP IS PREDICTED FOR COUNTRY THIS YEAR

WASHINGTON, April 8.—The largest crop of winter wheat ever grown was forecast for this year by the department of agriculture today, basing its estimate on conditions existing April 1. The enormous yield of 837, which at the government's guarantee of 000,000 bushels was announced, fixed price of \$2.25 a bushel, places the value of the crop at \$1,891,620,000.

This year's winter wheat crop, if no unfavorable conditions develop between now and time for harvest, will be 152,000,000 bushels larger than the previous record crop produced in 1914 and 248,000,000 bushels more than was grown last year.

RETURNED SOLDIERS BECOMING PEDDLERS TO EARN LIVING

WASHINGTON, April 4.—So many American soldiers have returned from the glories of European battlefields to the inglorious occupation of peddling for a livelihood that the war department is considerably perturbed and is taking steps to find more dignified employment for the peddler veterans.

A Standard Test for Gasoline

The third of a series of three statements

War needs made prominent the question of a standard test for gasoline. On July 31st, 1918, President Wilson ordered a committee appointed under the United States Fuel Administration to establish specifications and standards of test for gasoline supplied to the Government. This committee consisted of the United States Fuel Administration and representatives of the War and Navy Departments, the United States Shipping Board, the Director General of Railroads, the Bureau of Mines, and the Bureau of Standards. Standards were adopted for aviation gasoline (export, fighting and domestic) and for general motor use on land and sea.

The Gravity Test Discarded

The Government's Committee on Standardization of Petroleum Specifications stated in its report: "It will be noted that there are no gravity limitations in the specifications for aviation gasoline, nor in the specifications for motor gasoline which are given later, for it has been found that gravity is of little or no value in determining the quality of gasoline." The standards adopted by the United States Government are based on boiling points.

Boiling Points the Real Test

Gasoline is known to the refiner as one member of the petroleum family. He distinguishes each member of the family, not by gravity, but by boiling points. Gravity is a fleeting standard of test, but boiling points are unchanging in their value and always determine the quality of the product. Knowing them the refiner can keep his product uniform and reliable.

What Is a Boiling Point?

A boiling point is the temperature at which a liquid will begin to boil or vaporize.

In distilling a given quantity of gasoline the refiner ascertains at what point each 10 per cent will boil, until the entire quantity is evaporated or distilled. In this way he determines what is known as the initial boiling point, as well as all intervening boiling points in the chain, up to the maximum, high boiling point.

Boiling Points Tell the Story

Boiling points determine the vaporizing and combustible qualities of gasoline. They decide the action of the gas developed from gasoline. They are the only true measure of gasoline value.

An ideal gasoline has boiling points in a continuous, uniform chain. There must not be too many low boiling points, otherwise the loss in

storage by evaporation would be great. There must be just enough low boiling points to vaporize freely and give easy starting. The higher boiling points are necessary for quick acceleration, high power and long mileage.

As combustion starts with the lowest boiling points and flashes on through the gas, the continuous chain of boiling points—from the low to the high—is necessary for instantaneous, full-powered combustion. Only a straight-distilled, all-refinery gasoline can have the continuous, uniform chain of boiling points.

The United States Government Standard Specifications for Gasoline

The United States Government standard specifications for gasoline are based on boiling points—not gravity. Drafted as they were by impartial Government experts, they are generally considered, in the light of conditions today, as the most practical standard for gasoline. They insure an efficient and satisfactory gasoline and at the same time have due regard for the best utilization of our petroleum resources, and the maintenance of reasonable prices to the consumer.

Red Crown Gasoline Conforms to United States Government Standard

All Red Crown gasoline now being supplied in the Pacific Coast States is refined to conform to the United States Government Standard specifications. It is straight-distilled, all-refinery gasoline having the full, uniform chain of boiling points necessary for full-powered, dependable gasoline: Low boiling points for easy starting, medium boiling points for quick, smooth acceleration, and high boiling points for power and mileage.

STANDARD OIL COMPANY

(California)

